

Mapping the world

Maps are a way of picturing the world. They can show a small area, such as your neighbourhood, or a very large area, such as the whole world. Different types of map show different things. Some show countries, while others may just show physical features, such as rivers and mountains.

Lines of latitude are drawn across the map.

Different colours are used for different countries, which are also named.

The equator is an imaginary line around the middle of the Earth.

Lines of longitude run from the top to the bottom of the map.

Political world map

A political map shows you the countries of the world. You see where borders and cities are, including national capitals. Imaginary, numbered lines – the equator and lines of latitude and longitude – give you the exact position on Earth of places they pass through.

Physical map

This type of map shows you the natural features in an area. These include mountains, volcanoes, rivers, lakes, seas, oceans, and deserts. Different colours and symbols are used to represent these features.



KEY

-  Forest area
-  Water
-  Dry land
-  Mountains
-  River